

Table 22: Effect of activation steering on general capabilities (Llama-3.1-8B-Instruct, layers 4-9-15). Steering at $|\alpha|=0.8$ produces modest accuracy drops, confirming the intervention does not catastrophically degrade reasoning. MMLU results are on 500 randomly sampled questions across all subjects.

Dataset	Baseline	$\alpha = -0.8$	Δ	$\alpha = +0.8$	Δ
GSM8K ($n=1319$)	84.8	82.9	-1.9	81.8	-3.0
MMLU ($n=500$)	61.4	59.8	-1.6	60.2	-1.2